OCTESSERA

quick reference

Controls, bindings, behaviors, and Play pages across two pages.

regular controls

Turn Main	**Navigate/edit.** Numeric: plain coarse; *Fn* fine; *Shift* and *Shift*+*Fn* stay coarse. Enum, boolean, and text turns stay ordinary.
Click Main	**Menu selection** / select, edit, confirm
Back	**Exit location** / exit edit, overlay, or menu level
Play	**Transport** / play or pause
Shift + *Play*	**Stop** / external sync arms a one-shot resync
Fn + *Play*	**Reset stop** / stop, reset position, silence owned notes
Fn + turn Main right	**Single step** / advance one tick while paused/stopped
Shift + *Back*	**Clear layer** / re-initialize active layer
Shift + *Fn* + *Main*	**Context help** / hold modifiers, click menu item

navigation + bindings

Fn + left column	**Navigate to Layer 1-8** / bottom row = layer 1
Hold Fn	**Preview** / layers and Play pages
Fn + right column	**Technical Play pages** / Mix, Pan, Route, Tempo, LFO
Shift + *Fn* + right column	**Musical Play pages** / FX, XY, Transpose, Rate, Trigger Gate
Shift + *Fn* + left column	**Gate a layer** / its triggers off, press again to restore
Fn + *Aux click*	**Bind focused value/action** / value to turn, action to click
Fn + click *Main*	**Open Aux mapping** / 12-slot scrollable modal

Aux map: stays open after you release *Fn*; turn *Main* to scroll, click *Main* or press *Back* to close.

Auto-map fills unbound Aux turns and clicks for this menu area; manual wins unless **Aux Prio.** is **Auto**.

Aux markers: row caps show the Aux (1-3 pips, bar: *Shift* bank); footer: turn, click with `!`.

special grid modes

Sample assign	*Shift* + tile maps row; *Shift* + *Fn* + tile maps column
Drum assign	*Shift*+tile: row; *Shift*+*Fn*+tile: column; Tile Tune: one tile
Probability map	Never, low, high, always. *Shift*+tile: row; *Shift*+*Fn*+tile: column

patch orientation

1. Route **sequencer** or **looper** to **sampler** for a rhythm loop.
2. Add **life**, **raindrops**, **bounce**, or **dla** to a **synth**.
3. Use probability on sequencer tiles so patterns feel alive.
4. Bind aux encoders to parameters or actions you keep reaching for.

behaviors

none	Inactive layer	keys	Finger-drumming
sequencer	Manual rhythm anchor	looper	Recorded grid gestures
life	Birth/survival/death cells	brain	Pulses and trails
ant	Walking grid agent	bounce	Moving collisions
shapes	Geometric regions	raindrops	Drops and ripples
dla	Branching growth		

Triggers: `activate` tile turns on; `stable` stays on; `deactivate` turns off; `scanned` scanner finds a lit tile; `scanned empty` scanner visits a dark one.

play pages

Mix	Volumes; bottom row mutes (never saved). *Shift*: B1-B4 + master.
Pan	Rows are instruments, left to right; bus-routed ones move their bus pan
Route	Bottom five rows: direct or B1-B4. Row 6: FX bypass, B1-B4 + Global 1-2. Top row: duck key. Press again to undo.
Tempo	50-240 BPM ladder, Tap top-left, a -4..+4 nudge row, then Swing A:B (`4:4` straight)
LFO	Row per LFO: on/off, then 1/8 to 8 bars (again: triplet). *Shift*: depth.
FX	Press mapped tiles to trigger live effects
XY	Two-axis surface for mapped parameters. *Shift* + press latches; **Glide** smooths it.
Transpose	Synth, FM, Plucked & enabled MIDI; Sampler/Drum when **Follow Transp.** is on
Rate	Step rate per layer. *Shift*: Scan Unit. Lit tile: resync at the next bar.
Trigger Gate	Per layer: block, custom probability, or allow

good to know

Aux turns: numbers coarse, *Fn* fine; the *Shift* bank with *Shift* (*Shift*+*Fn* fine). Lists move one option.

Factory preset hint: **life** on Layer 1, **sequencer** rhythm on Layer 2.

Sample browser: `..` parent, `[folder]` folder, `(empty)` nothing; *Play* previews. Long names clip or scroll.

Display: `System > Display > Home Visual` draws the master as scope, spectrum or waterfall on the home page. **Signal** on an instrument, bus or Global FX fills the screen with that sound; click *Main* to flip views. **Main Font** / **Small Font**: Octessera or Original.

Bench safety: Power through the enclosure USB-C breakout; remove both the board microSD card and OLED microSD card before closing the case.

> If the grid behaves unexpectedly, check the OLED. You are probably in an overlay or Play page. Use *Back* or *Fn* to leave.

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tile state to sound

From behavior state and direct input to MIDI, internal audio, routing, and optional live FX.

